# Fallen Hem Fixes

*When a skirt, dress, or coat hem sags open midday, you can rescue it before you even take your coat off. Fast fix first, proper fix after.*

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**What you need:**

- Fast fix: a safety pin
- Proper fix: needle and matching thread, scissors

## The 60-second rescue (no sewing)

1. Tuck the torn edge back inside the hem fold, matching it to the crease line that already exists.
2. Close a safety pin and fasten it through the fold, catching the folded hem and the lining beneath, angled so the pin lies flat.
3. Smooth the fabric down. The pin holds the fold invisibly until you get home. Nobody will see it because it lives inside the fold.

## The proper repair (10 minutes of sewing)

1. Remove the old, loose stitches along the fallen section with scissors or a seam ripper. Pin out any leftover thread bits.
2. If the hem edge is fraying, run a dab of fray-check glue or a tiny zigzag of glue along the raw edge and let it dry a few minutes. No glue? Overcast the raw edge with a few loose whip stitches instead.
3. Thread a needle (single thread is fine for delicate fabrics), knot the end, and hide the knot inside the fold of the hem.
4. Whipstitch or slipstitch a short section at a time: catch one or two threads of the main fabric with each stitch, then slide the needle inside the hem fold.
5. Keep the stitches a loose, relaxed tension. Tight stitches pull the hem into a ripple, which is the one thing that makes a repair obvious.
6. When you finish, knot off inside the fold, trim the thread, and give the whole hem a press with the iron at the fabric's allowed setting.

> **If the hem was machined:** you can restitch it by hand along the same old stitch holes, which keeps the repair almost invisible. Follow the dotted line the old thread left behind.

**Kind tips:** A fallen hem is fabric fatigue, not a mistake by you. These hems come loose because they get worn, which means they're the good clothes.